INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Market Planning

RETAIL MERCHANDISING SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Explain the concept of market and market identification.
2. Explain the role of situation analysis in the marketing planning process.
3. Explain the concept of marketing strategies.
4. Identify product's/service's competitive advantage.
5. Plan special events.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the assistant manager at HOLLOWAY HARDWARE, a family-owned hardware store that has been in business for 48 years. The owner (judge) wants your ideas on how the store should respond to new competition.

A national home improvement chain will open a store three miles away next spring. HOLLOWAY's sales dropped 9% last year as more customers ordered tools and supplies online. About 70% of HOLLOWAY's regular customers are over age 55.

There is also an opportunity. A new neighborhood with 640 homes is being built one mile from the store. Most buyers are young families and first-time homeowners. Many of them have never done home repairs and don't know where to start.

The owner (judge) wants you to:

- Explain who HOLLOWAY's current market is and identify new markets the store could reach.
- Explain how a situation analysis would help the store prepare for the new competitor.
- Explain what a marketing strategy is and recommend one for HOLLOWAY.
- Identify HOLLOWAY's competitive advantage over the big-box store and online sellers.
- Plan a special event that would bring new customers into the store.

You will present your ideas to the owner (judge) in a meeting at the store. The owner (judge) will begin the meeting by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and answered the owner's (judge's) questions, the owner (judge) will conclude the meeting by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. How do we attract the new homeowners without losing the customers who've shopped here for decades?
2. How will we know if the special event actually brought in new customers?

	Rate the participant's ability to:	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Explain the concept of market and market identification.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Explain the role of situation analysis in the marketing planning process.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Explain the concept of marketing strategies.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Identify product's/service's competitive advantage.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Plan special events.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
4.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
5.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
7.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
8.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
10.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	